17. Of Assam's total population of 3,12,05,576 in 2011, 1,06,79,345 were Muslim. Census 2011 data, https://censusindia.gov.in/2011census/Religion_PCA.html.
18. Census 2011, data tables, https://censusindia.gov.in/2011census/Religion_PCA.html.
19. Amit Shah press conference on 3 March 2018, https://youtu.be/v6Kd5CJKhvM.
20. At Ideas Exchange hosted by *The Indian Express*, quoted in Rajat Sethi and Shubhrastha, *The Last Battle of Saraighat: The Story of the BJP's Rise in the North-East* (New Delhi: Penguin, 2017).
21. Nishant Kumar Azad interview with Sunil Deodhar, 'We have cultivated "kesar" (saffron) in the red desert', *Organiser*, Vol. 69, No. 38, 18 March 2018.
22. Amit Shah press conference on 3 March 2018: https://youtu.be/v6Kd5CJKhvM.
23. BJP YouTube: 'सूरज जब ढलता है तो लाल रंग का होता है और जब उगता है तो केसरिया रंग का होता है: पीएम मोदी', 4 May 2018, https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=Cz7rtInD45s.
24. Narendra Modi YouTube Channel video in Guwahati, 'North East is the Ashta Lakshmi of India; Lotus and Lakshmi are closely linked: Shri Modi', 10 February 2014, https://youtu.be/R65kan8fM3k. Modi spoke in Hindi; translation is mine.
25. For more on Lakshmi manifestations, see Vasudha Narayanan, 'ŚRĪ: Giver of fortune, bestower of grace' in John Stratton Hawley, Donna Marie Wulff (eds), *Devī: Goddesses of India* (Berkeley: University of California Press, 1996), p. 104.
26. Narendra Modi speech on 29 November 2014. Full text available at: https://www.narendramodi.in/text-of-prime-ministers-address-at-the-flagging-off-of-the-first-train-from-mendipathar-meghalaya-to-guwahati-2908. See the video of the speech at: https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=y0SQ5mPzcDc.
27. BJP President Amit Shah further emphasised this point on June 2018. Abhishek Saha, 'Amit Shah: Prime Minister Narendra Modi regards North East as Ashta Lakshmi', *The Indian Express*, 19